

# Dr. Christopher Dillon

Global Lead Data Scientist · Head of Data

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Northern Ireland

## EXPERIENCE

### Global Lead Data Scientist

Jan 2025 - Present

Nexus Brands Group

Defined and built the data strategy, infrastructure, and team for a group of 18 businesses. Formed the global data team — owning the full stack from data warehousing and ETL through to executive dashboards and advanced analytics.

- **Business impact:** +25% OTIF across the group; identified £Xm (figure withheld) in excess & obsolete inventory; recovered ~1% of revenue previously lost to out-of-stock
- **Team:** Built and lead a team of PhD-level data scientists and engineers supporting senior leadership across the group
- **Infrastructure:** Replaced fragmented legacy reporting with a single Streamlit stack (Entra SSO) serving strategic KPIs down to operational detail
- **KPI strategy:** Designed and rolled out EOS L10 scorecards across all departments
- **Advanced analytics:** Customer segmentation, margin optimisation, strategic growth initiatives

### European Data Scientist

Apr 2023 - Jan 2025

Nexus Brands Group

Built the data function from scratch for 5 European businesses across tattoo, beauty, and pet grooming supply. Consolidated fragmented data sources into a unified data warehouse, enabling consistent automated reporting across all entities. Promoted to Global Lead Data Scientist based on this work.

### Data Scientist

May 2022 - Apr 2023

Christies Direct (now part of Nexus Brands Group)

Established the Data Science function from scratch at one of the world's largest pet-grooming supply companies. Created unified reporting across Christies and sister company Transgroom. Promoted to European Data Scientist as the business was acquired into Nexus Brands Group.

### Astrophysics PhD

Sep 2017 - Feb 2022

Queen's University Belfast

PhD project: *Observations and Modelling of Intensity Time series for Biomedical and Astrophysical Applications* — joint venture between Queen's and Randox. Developed statistical techniques for below-noise-floor signals, applied to both stellar lightcurves and biochip diagnostics. Led to novel discoveries of stellar nanoflares (published in ApJ) and to image feature recognition software now embedded in Randox's biochip pipeline — 98.8% reduction in downstream processing time in a \$12B diagnostics market. Primarily IDL and Python. Redacted thesis.

## PUBLICATIONS

|      |                                                                                                                            |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 | <b>Nanoflare Activity on Fully Convective M-dwarf Stars</b><br>Grant et al. The Astrophysical Journal                      |
| 2020 | <b>Statistical Evidence for Stellar Nanoflare Signals in M-type Lightcurves</b><br>Dillon et al. The Astrophysical Journal |
| 2019 | <b>Monte Carlo Techniques for Nanoflare Detection in Solar Active Regions</b><br>Jess et al. The Astrophysical Journal     |

## EDUCATION

### MSci Physics, First Class Honours

Sep 2013 - Jun 2017

Queen's University Belfast

Seagate bursary recipient. Head of peer mentor scheme.

## SKILLS

### BUILD

Python  
SQL  
Polars  
DuckDB  
Streamlit  
Docker  
Git  
Claude Code

### LEAD

Data strategy  
Hiring  
Team development  
Stakeholder management  
Cross-functional delivery

### SHIP

Swift / SwiftUI  
Indie Mac and iOS apps (PARKER, Pascal, Nyquist)